ZIL MONEY / KNOWLEDGE BASE

The Zil Money v4 UI Rebrand and Consistency Pass

A plain-language, phase-by-phase guide to the colour theme, the shared components, and how every screen stays consistent

PRODUCT	WORKSTREAM	AUDIENCE	STATUS
Zil Money web app (v4)	design/zilmoney-rebrand	Design, Dev, QA, PM	In design review

Overview

The v4 UI rebrand and consistency programme re-skins the Zil Money web app to the Zil Money brand and gives it **one colour system, one sizing standard, one button system and one set of component states**, applied the same way on every screen and meeting WCAG 2.2 AA in both themes. It ran from 2 October to 13 October 2026 on a design branch, in five stages: brand tokens and baseline, palette exploration, screen-by-screen UX passes, accessibility compliance, and a final consistency pass.

Before the programme, the app carried the Online Check Writer look: legacy blues and a neon green, a mix of fonts, text below 12px, placeholder-only fields, 2.5:1 greys, undersized inputs, and colours typed by hand inside hundreds of components. Dropdowns came in several heights and radii, dark mode turned brand cards into glowing blocks, and busy screens such as Send Payment and the bank account pages carried badges and labels that repeated what the user already knew.

The journey, in plain terms:

- Stage 1 (2 Oct): the brand becomes tokens. Inter font, 8px radius, a contrast-verified text scale, 44/40/32px sizing tiers, and a scripted sweep that retires legacy hex values from 388 files.
- Stage 2 (3 to 6 Oct): the primary colour is explored on real screens. Cerulean, a deep teal, then Slate, then the navy `#004a7c`, with indigo and calm-teal comparison builds kept side by side.
- Stage 3 (3 to 7 Oct): screen passes. Send Payment, the header launcher, bank accounts, modals, section hub pages and the dashboard are decluttered and compacted, and the rules that came out of review are written down.
- Stage 4 (9 to 10 Oct): WCAG 2.2 AA. Tokens are fixed first, then components are swept for colour-only status, faint financial copy and unnamed icon buttons. A contrast script guards the result. Compliance notices get a calm tone.

- Stage 5 (13 Oct): consistency. Dropdown rows, add-new tiles, banners, dividers, modal surfaces and dark-mode brand cards are unified, two long modals are simplified, and the reference, change log and this knowledge base are produced.

FACT	DETAIL
Timeline	2 October to 13 October 2026. Seventeen commits on the design branch plus working changes, captured as four design snapshots on 6, 6, 9 and 13 October.
Scope	All v4 screens of the Zil Money web app: login, header and sidebar, dashboard, section hub pages, Send Payment, bank accounts, Verification Center, payee, card, category and support modals, wallet and bank lists. Classic v3 and v3.5 screens untouched.
Primary palette	Navy primary `#004a7c`, teal accent `#00a5b2`, light-blue page `#f2f7fb`, Inter for all text, 8px radius. Dark mode swaps every token on the same markup.
Accessibility bar	WCAG 2.2 AA app-wide since 9 October: text 4.5:1, control boundaries 3:1, no status by colour alone, financial and consent copy never fainter than body text. A script in the repo checks the token pairs.
Comparison builds	Three local builds that differ only in colour (navy, the earlier indigo, a calm teal) so stakeholders can compare palettes on identical screens. Every change is applied to all three.
Status	Design programme complete on the design branch. Not yet merged. Review pack delivered to the dev and QA teams.

How we talk about it (guardrails)

- This is a design-branch pass. Nothing here is live until the dev team merges it through the normal pipeline.
- "Consistent" means the same token and the same recipe, not merely "looks similar".
- The accessibility bar is a hard rule. A softer look never buys its way past a contrast failure.
- Open items are listed honestly. Anything not fixed is named, with the reason.

Knowledge

The master brief. Read this once and you understand everything that changed between 2 and 13 October, and why.

The programme in full

The work ran in five stages. Each stage built on the one before, and the rules that came out of review in one stage became the standard for the next.

Stage 1. Brand tokens and the UX baseline (2 October)

The whole app was re-skinned to the Zil Money brand at the token level so every white-label build changed at once. Inter became the only typeface, the corner radius became 8px, and the text scale was rebuilt so that body, label, helper and placeholder text all clear 4.5:1 on white. A sizing standard was set from live competitor measurement: **44px for form fields and buttons, 40px for dense toolbars and filters, 32px inside table cells**, with labels always visible at 14px medium, a 2px brand focus ring, and a 12px floor for all text. A scripted sweep then replaced legacy brand hex values, low-contrast greys and sub-12px text across 388 files. On Send Payment the bank account dropdown was decluttered and the account number masked in the trigger. An attempt to render the page at 100% instead of its 0.85 zoom was reverted on review because the result felt bulky; the rule that came out of it is to declutter before enlarging.

Stage 2. Choosing the primary colour (3 to 6 October)

The brand guide's Cerulean was tried first. A deep teal from a colour recommendation was previewed on the sidebar, header, dashboard and Send Payment. Slate `#415a80` was then adopted app-wide for buttons, links, focus and selection. On 6 October the main copy moved to the navy `#004a7c` with a light-blue page, and two comparison builds were created that share every layout change but keep a different palette: the earlier indigo `#20319d` on a pink-tinted page, and a calm teal `#0f766e` on warm off-white, inspired by how competitors sit one restrained accent on a neutral canvas. A sync script keeps all three identical apart from colour.

Stage 3. Screen passes (3 to 7 October)

- **Header.** A "+" quick-actions launcher at the start of the top bar, with favourites inside its panel. A standalone gold Favourites button was tried next to it and removed on 7 October so the header keeps a single launcher. Tile descriptions were rewritten in plain English.
- **Sidebar.** Solid primary fill restored on the selected item.
- **Bank accounts.** A compact "All Bank Accounts" summary strip, the Transactions heading moved into the toolbar row with a tighter section gap, an Edit Bank Account modal regrouped into sections, Account and Info tabs on the detail panel, and later a card redesign with Info merged into Account.
- **Send Payment.** First-view compaction, one-line account rows, taller dropdown panels, a compact bank verification modal, and the rule that a verified account shows a tick and a short "ACH" chip, never the word "Verified".
- **Modals app-wide.** A compact dialog rhythm and unified labels; payee and card modals brought onto the shared recipe.
- **Section hub pages and dashboard.** Section-page cards and banner rebalanced, the CTA banner moved onto the primary colour, dashboard wallet and upcoming-payment cards, and a light-blue page background throughout.

- **Verification Center.** Re-laid on the shared cards with the current step in focus.

Stage 4. WCAG 2.2 AA (9 to 10 October)

A compliance requirement made AA the app-wide bar. The audit measured 18 of 26 token pairs passing in light mode and 19 of 26 in dark. The fix went token-first: success green, warning amber and error red were darkened in light mode and lightened in dark, the error, sky and warning badge text tokens were corrected, and the field border moved from a 1.5:1 grey to `#7c8fa3` at 3.3:1. Those ten changes repaired roughly 1,300 usages at once. A component sweep then followed: brand text on dark surfaces switched to the bold token, status dots and coloured amounts gained words or signs, icon-only buttons gained accessible names, and faint fee, warning and consent copy was raised to body weight. A Node script, `tools/contrast-check.mjs`, now checks every audited pair and fails on any regression. In the same stage the Verification Center's compliance requests were given a calm tone: re-verification and missing-details notices are neutral and never red, only enhanced due diligence uses amber, and the success family moved to emerald.

Stage 5. Consistency (13 October)

With the palette and the bar settled, the last stage made every screen use the same recipe. Hand-typed indigo on the Bulk Payment Center became white tints and tokens; the brand surfaces gained a dark-mode navy; feature icon tiles lost the slate accent; the CTA banner button became the teal fill; the Instant Demo, Add Category and Add payee modals were simplified; the wallet list matched the bank and card lists; the nine Send Payment dropdowns were unified in row, mask and add-new tile; and a read-only audit of buttons, dropdowns, modals, tables and states produced a fixed list and an open list. The UI reference, the change log and this knowledge base were written.

What changed, screen by screen

SCREEN	CHANGE ACROSS THE PROGRAMME
Login	Rebranded hero on the brand surface; Inter; new field and button sizes.
Header and sidebar	"+" launcher with favourites inside; plain-English tiles; solid selected item; gold favourite stars on tiles.
Dashboard	Wallet and upcoming-payment cards; Bulk Payment Center on tokens with teal main action; dark-mode navy surface.
Section hub pages	Cards and banner rebalanced; CTA banner on the primary, then on the dark-aware banner token with a teal button; icon tiles on primary, sky and teal only.
Send Payment	Compact first view; one-line account rows; masked trigger; verified tick and ACH chip; nine dropdowns on one recipe with a four-dot mask and a dashed add-new tile.
Bank accounts	Summary strip; toolbar heading; Edit modal regrouped; Account and Info merged into one card; compact verification modal.
Verification Center	Shared step cards; calm, neutral re-verification requests; amber reserved for enhanced due diligence.

SCREEN	CHANGE ACROSS THE PROGRAMME
Modals	Compact rhythm and unified labels; payee modal restructured with an entity chooser and optional-details chips; send-link form fixed; Add Category on one surface; Instant Demo primary action by availability.
Lists	Wallet list dividers and selection rail matched to bank and card lists.
Global	Tokens for every colour; text, badge and border tokens AA-compliant; sizing tiers; focus ring; dropdown radius; hover token; checkbox and radio states; contrast script.

Decisions that became rules

DECISION	RULE FROM IT
100% zoom felt bulky (2 Oct)	Declutter first. Remove repeated badges, icons and labels before making anything bigger.
Slate, then navy primary (3 and 6 Oct)	One primary for buttons, links, focus and selection; comparison palettes live in separate builds, never mixed on a screen.
Verified shown twice (5 Oct)	A tick icon with an accessible name means verified. The short "ACH" chip marks ACH-enabled accounts. The word "Verified" is never a badge.
Favourites button removed (7 Oct)	The header has one launcher. Favourites live inside the "+" panel.
AA app-wide (9 Oct)	Contrast is a hard rule. Fix tokens first, then sweep components. A brand colour is not an exemption.
Red re-verification rejected (10 Oct)	Compliance requests are calm and neutral. Only enhanced due diligence may use amber. Success is emerald.
Field border lightening reverted (13 Oct)	Containers use the light card border; only fields use the darker field border, which sits at the 3:1 floor.
Same recipe everywhere (13 Oct)	Rows, tiles, banners and dividers share one class string per component, so a change lands once.

Who benefits

For users: one calm product in light and dark, fields and buttons large enough to use, text that can be read, status that is never colour alone, and busy screens stripped of repeated labels.

For the team: a new screen can be built from the reference without a design review for the basics. A colour change is a token edit. The contrast script catches regressions. The audit's open items are a ready-made backlog.

Internal FAQ

- *Which palette is final?* The navy `#004a7c` is the main copy. Indigo and calm teal exist as comparison builds for the management decision.

- *Why Inter everywhere?* The brand guide specifies it, and one typeface removed a mix of legacy fonts.
- *Why teal on the banner buttons when white text on teal is about 3:1?* Chosen on review for brand reasons. It is the one deliberate exception and is recorded as such.
- *Why did the field borders get darker, not lighter?* The old grey measured 1.5:1. The boundary rule needs 3:1. The container borders stayed light so the screens still read as soft.
- *Is any of this in production?* No. It is on the design branch and in the three comparison builds. Classic v3 and v3.5 screens were not touched.

Definition of success

The Knowledge phase is done when any designer or developer can read this pack and the UI reference, name the token, size tier or recipe for a given element without asking, explain the five stages and the rules that came out of them, and list the exceptions and why they exist.

BA

Objective

Agree how we will know the rebrand and consistency pass worked, in measurable terms, before it ships.

Investigation and analysis

Most of the value here is qualitative, so the measures lean on things that can be counted in the codebase and in review, with a small set of user-facing checks after release.

Thinking seed

- Count of hand-typed hex colours in v4 templates and styles. The baseline before this pass was in the dozens; the target is zero outside documented exceptions.
- Count of distinct dropdown and button recipes in the v4 app. The audit found several of each; the target is one per component.
- Contrast script result: every token pair passes, every build, as a gate.
- Guardrail: no regression in form completion on Send Payment and Add payee after the modal restructure.
- Guardrail: zero accessibility defects raised against focus visibility or colour-only status.

Working strategy

Record the baseline counts from the audit, keep the contrast script in the pipeline, and schedule one post-release review of the two restructured modals with support tickets as the signal.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the counts above have a baseline, a target and an owner, the contrast gate is agreed, and the post-release review is on the calendar.

03 | To Do

To Do

Objective

Turn the design-branch work into merge-ready, reviewable pieces.

Investigation and analysis

The branch holds roughly 620 changed files, most of them from the earlier accessibility pass. They split naturally into: tokens and global styles, shared components, page-level changes, modal restructures, and documentation.

Thinking seed

- Which slice can merge first with the lowest risk? Tokens and global style fixes change the look everywhere but touch few files.
- Which changes alter behaviour rather than style? The Add payee restructure and the send-link form are the two to review as features, with tests.
- What is the Definition of Done for a style change: contrast script green, lint clean, screens clicked through in light and dark.

Working strategy

Open one pull request per slice, in the order tokens, global styles, shared components, pages, modals, docs. Link the change log section for each. Flag the two behavioural changes for QA.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the branch is split into reviewable pull requests with acceptance criteria, the behavioural changes are flagged, and the Definition of Done is agreed.

UI/UX

This is the phase that carries the full design depth. The rules below are the ones every other phase relies on.

Colour theme

Brand

- Primary `#004a7c` (dark `#1d6aa5`)
- Brand text in dark mode `#8ec5ec`
- Teal accent `#00a5b2` (both modes)
- Brand banner, dark mode `#0c3d63`

Surfaces

- Page `#f2f7fb` (dark `#162034`)
- Card and input `#ffffff` (dark `#1c293c`)
- Container border `#e5e7eb` (dark `#3a3e47`)
- Field border `#7c8fa3` (dark `#6b7a90`)

Text

- Main `#111827`
- Secondary `#374151`
- Tertiary `#4b5563`
- Subtle and placeholder `#6b7280`

Status

- Success `#047857` on `#d1fae5`
- Warning `#a16207` on `#fef9c2`
- Error `#b91c1c` on `#ffe2e2`
- Info `#004a7c` on `#e6eff6`

> **Rules.** Containers use the container border; only form fields use the field border. Status chips stay light in dark mode. Compliance notices are neutral, never red; only enhanced due diligence is amber. Verified bank accounts show a tick and a short "ACH" chip, never the word "Verified".

Buttons

VARIANT	RECIPE
Primary	Navy fill, white text, 44px, 14px semibold, 8px radius. One per view or modal.
Outline	White fill, 2px navy border, brand text. The Cancel and secondary action.
Destructive	Red fill, white text. Confirm dialogs only.
Compact	32px, 13px, 4px radius. Toolbars, cards, table actions.
On brand surfaces	Main action is the teal fill with white text; supporting actions are a 15% white tint with a 30% white border.
States	Hover darkens 8% and lifts; focus shows a 2px brand ring; active presses to 98%; disabled is 45% opacity and desaturated; loading disables the button and spins a 16px icon after the label.

Component states

- **Fields:** 44px, field border, brand border plus ring on focus, red border and a shaking message on error after the field is touched, 50% opacity when disabled, red asterisk for required, "(optional)" in the label

otherwise.

- **Dropdowns:** 44px control, 12px radius, brand border on hover and when open, 2px brand border once a value is chosen, 12px panel with 44px rows and a 240px scroll height. In modals the panel attaches to the body so it never clips.
- **Choice rows:** 28px icon tile that fills navy when selected, 13px bold name with the masked number beside it, page-tint hover, brand-tint selection, 3px gap between rows, dashed green "Add new" tile at the top.
- **Modals:** 20px shell, one surface for header, body and footer, title 20px semibold with a 12px subtitle, close icon top right, Cancel outline then primary at 120px each.
- **Empty:** one white card with a 60px icon circle, 18px title, one helper line and one compact primary action. Never a fake list skeleton.
- **Loading:** shimmer skeletons for tables and panels, a spinning icon inline, a full-screen blurred overlay only for whole-page waits.
- **Feedback:** centred alert dialogs for success, failure, info and warning; inline banners on the success, warning and error surfaces; no toasts.

Simplicity patterns from this pass

- Required fields in one card. A clear, separate choice (Individual or Business) with pill buttons that say what the choice changes.
- Optional sections as a single row of dashed chips, opened one at a time, with a tick once completed and a red "Required" tag when a choice makes them mandatory.
- Controls that only mirror derived state are removed and replaced with a status line, as with the send-link checkboxes.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every v4 element can be traced to a token and a recipe in the UI reference, dark mode is reviewed on every changed screen, and the deliberate exceptions are listed with their contrast figures.

Compliance Sign-off

Objective

Confirm the pass changes nothing about what data is collected or shown, and that accessibility obligations are met.

Investigation and analysis

The restructured Add payee modal moves fields around but collects the same data. The send-link form still sends the same email and SMS flags; it only removed controls that could not be operated. No new personal data is captured and no masking was weakened: account numbers are still shown as the last four digits only.

Thinking seed

- Does the four-dot mask beside the name reveal anything the previous format did not? It shows the same last four digits.
- Does the Individual or Business choice change which fields are required in a way Legal needs to know? It makes company name and address required for a business, as before.
- Is the accessibility bar documented well enough to cite in an audit?

Working strategy

Walk Compliance through the two restructured forms with before-and-after screenshots, confirm no change to data capture, consent or masking, and attach the contrast report.

Definition of success

The phase is done when Compliance confirms no change to data collection or exposure, and the accessibility evidence is accepted.

Development

Objective

Merge the design-branch work safely, keep the token system as the single source of colour, and leave the codebase easier to extend.

Investigation and analysis

The concrete surfaces engineering will touch: the light and dark theme files and the theme emitter that turns them into CSS variables; the Tailwind config that maps those variables to utility classes; the global overrides file for dropdowns, checkboxes and radios; the shared button, input, dropdown and main-page layout components; the page data file that assigns icon colours to feature tiles; and the Add payee, Add Category and Instant Demo modal components. The new shared wallet intro component and the two documents under the design-system docs folder are additions.

Thinking seed

- Keep the three colour builds in step. Every change goes to the main copy, then the sync script re-applies it to the other two with their colour swap.
- The dropdown height tiers exist twice. Decide which set survives and delete the other before more screens are added.
- Forty hand-rolled primary buttons remain in twenty-four files. Migrate them to the shared button in a dedicated pull request.
- Modal shells are repeated by hand in over a hundred templates. A shared shell component would retire most of the remaining inconsistency.
- The error message component still uses a FontAwesome icon; the repo standard is Lucide.

Working strategy

Merge in slices as planned in To Do, run the contrast script and lint on each, click through light and dark for every touched screen, and keep the UI reference and change log current as part of the pull request.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the slices are merged, no v4 screen carries a hard-coded colour outside documented exceptions, the contrast gate is green, and the docs match what shipped.

07 | QA Scheduled

QA Scheduled

Objective

Plan a visual and functional test pass that covers every changed screen in both themes.

Investigation and analysis

The change log lists the screens. The behavioural changes are the Add payee modal (entity choice, optional chips, send link) and the Instant Demo modal (primary action depends on expert availability). Everything else is visual.

Thinking seed

- Edge cases: a business payee saved without an address; an individual payee with a company name; a send link with phone only; edit mode on an existing payee; no expert online in the demo modal.
- Theme cases: every changed screen in light and dark, including the brand banners and the demo modal's blue panel.
- Keyboard: tab through the entity pills, the optional chips and the dropdown rows; the focus ring must be visible at every stop.

Working strategy

Write the cases from the change log, pair each with a screenshot from the reference, and assign a tester and a date.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every changed screen has a light and a dark case, the behavioural edge cases are written, and the keyboard pass is scheduled.

In QA

Objective

Run the cases and prove the screens match the reference in both themes.

Investigation and analysis

Compare each screen with the screenshots captured during the design pass. Differences in spacing, radius, hover or selection are defects even when the colour is right.

Thinking seed

- Does a dropdown panel inside a modal ever clip at the modal edge?
- Does the Add payee modal still submit correctly for each payee type and entity choice?
- Do the three comparison builds show identical layouts, differing only in colour?

Working strategy

Execute the plan, log defects against the change log entry they relate to, and re-test fixes in both themes.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every case has passed in both themes and no open defect touches a changed screen.

09 | QA Passed

QA Passed

Objective

Record that the pass is verified and ready to release.

Investigation and analysis

Collect the evidence: the executed test plan, the contrast report, lint and unit test results, and the final screenshots per theme.

Thinking seed

- Is every defect closed or explicitly deferred with an owner?
- Does the UI reference still match the verified screens?

Working strategy

Attach the evidence to the epic and update the status in the reference document.

Definition of success

The phase is done when QA has signed off with the evidence attached and the reference reflects the verified state.

Deployment

Objective

Ship the merged slices through the normal pipeline with a clean way back.

Investigation and analysis

Style changes are low risk individually but highly visible together. Shipping tokens first changes the look everywhere at once; shipping pages first leaves a mixed state. Tokens and global styles should go together, then the rest.

Thinking seed

- Does the white-label build for every brand still look right? A shared token change reaches all of them.
- Is the rollback a plain revert of the merge, with no data or config to undo?
- Is dark mode checked on the deployed build, not only locally?

Working strategy

Deploy slice by slice through the pipeline, check a brand build and both themes after each, and keep the revert path ready.

Definition of success

The phase is done when all slices are deployed, every brand build is checked, and the rollback path is confirmed unused or exercised cleanly.

Sales and Support Training

Objective

Make sure support can answer "the screen looks different" questions calmly and accurately.

Investigation and analysis

The visible changes customers may ask about: the navy and teal look, a darker and calmer dark mode, the shorter Add payee form with the Individual or Business choice, and the send-link form without checkboxes.

Thinking seed

- What does a user do if they cannot find the address fields? They are behind the Address chip under "Add optional details".
- What changed in the send-link form? The link goes to every channel they fill in; the checkboxes were never real controls.
- Nothing about pricing, limits or data handling changed.

Working strategy

Give support a one-page before-and-after with the four visible changes and the answers above.

Definition of success

The phase is done when support has the one-pager and can walk a customer through the Add payee form without escalation.

Marketing Training

Objective

Align public screenshots and brand assets with the new palette.

Investigation and analysis

Marketing material that shows app screens will look dated once the navy and teal ship. The palette values and the dark-mode rules are in the reference.

Thinking seed

- Which public pages and help articles show the old indigo screens?
- Should dark-mode screenshots be used anywhere? The dark palette is now presentable.

Working strategy

Share the palette card from the reference and a set of refreshed screenshots after deployment.

Definition of success

The phase is done when marketing has the palette and refreshed screenshots, and no live asset shows the retired palette.

Live BA Dashboard Preview

Objective

Show the measures from the BA phase on real data before management sign-off.

Investigation and analysis

The codebase counts (hard-coded colours, distinct recipes) come from a repository scan; the contrast gate comes from the pipeline; the form-completion guardrail comes from product analytics.

Thinking seed

- Is the hard-coded colour count at zero outside the documented exceptions?
- Has Send Payment or Add payee completion moved since release?
- Is anything presented as live that is still a manual count?

Working strategy

Present the counts and the guardrail trend with their sources, and label anything manual as such.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the measures are shown from their real sources and any gap has a named owner.

Management Approval

Objective

Get an explicit decision that the new look and the consistency rules are the standard going forward.

Investigation and analysis

Management chooses between the three colour builds and confirms the teal accent and the dark-mode navy. The two deliberate contrast exceptions need an explicit yes.

Thinking seed

- Navy, indigo or teal primary? The comparison builds exist for this decision.
- Is white text on the teal accent accepted as an exception, or should the fill be darkened?
- Is the open-items list funded as follow-up work?

Working strategy

Present the three builds on identical screens, the exception list with contrast figures, and the open-items backlog. Record the decisions.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the palette, the exceptions and the follow-up backlog are each decided with a named approver.

Done

Objective

Close the pass with the reference as the living standard.

Investigation and analysis

Confirm the deployed app matches the reference, the change log is complete, and the comparison builds are archived or retired.

Thinking seed

- Is the reference linked from the repo's contributor guide so new screens follow it?
- Are the two worktrees for colour comparison still needed?

Working strategy

Link the docs, retire the comparison builds once the palette is decided, and write the closing summary.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the reference is the linked standard, the comparison builds are retired, and the epic has a written summary.

BA Review

Objective

Check whether the pass achieved its goals and decide what comes next.

Investigation and analysis

Compare the codebase counts and guardrails with the baseline, and review how many new screens since release followed the reference without correction.

Thinking seed

- Did the recipe count stay at one per component, or did new variants creep in?
- Which open items caused real friction and should move up the backlog?
- Does the reference need a section it is missing?

Working strategy

Run the scan again, read the recent screens against the reference, and update the open-items list and the document.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the results are compared with the baseline, the follow-up work is prioritised, and the reference is updated.

Open items carried forward BACKLOG

ITEM	WHY IT IS OPEN
Modal shells	Most modal headers still use a different surface token; no shared shell component exists yet.
Dropdown height tiers	Two systems coexist. One must be deleted.
Hand-rolled buttons	Forty remain across twenty-four files with mixed radius and hover.
Error message icon	Uses FontAwesome; the standard is Lucide.
Empty-field border class	A legacy red border class is applied to empty inputs and only hidden by cascade order.
Field border softness	Any lighter value fails the 3:1 boundary check; needs a decision, not a tweak.
Teal CTA text contrast	White on teal is about 3:1; accepted on review as an exception.